

What classes are you taking, and which is your favorite?

This semester, I am taking an exit planning class, internship class, and an education psychology class. Although I enjoy all of my classes, my favorite is education psychology.

What do you like to do when you're not attending class?

I like hanging out with my roommate and seeing movies. I also enjoy listening to music, and my favorite genre is classic rock.

Can you name one thing that you learned about yourself while you've been at college?

One thing I have learned while in college is no matter how independent you are, it is okay to ask for help.

Who's the person who has helped you most on campus?

All the staff at CarolinaLIFE has been very helpful. My friends on campus have also been a big help.

What's good about college?

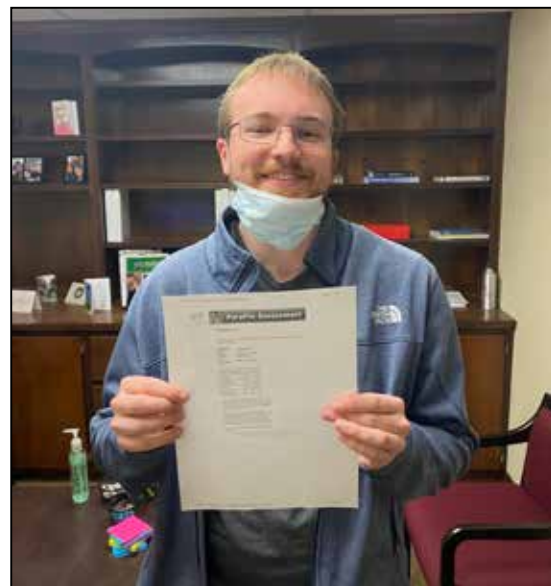
College has helped me become more independent and realize what I want to do with my life. I have been able to meet a lot of new people in college and I have enjoyed that. College is definitely not as scary as you think it is.

What do you hope to do after college, after you graduate or get your certificate?

After college, I want to work as a paraprofessional in a high school and gain more experience working in a school setting. Ultimately, I want to become a high school history teacher.

What advice do you have for young students with disabilities who aren't sure about college?

My advice to them would be is that even if you aren't sure about college, you should still look into college programs like CarolinaLIFE. Programs like CarolinaLIFE help you to discover what you want to do and can give you a lot of opportunities.



David showing off his paraprofessional certification!



Ultimately, I
want to become
a high school
history teacher.

—David Canipe

[Sign up](#) to receive our monthly newsletter for more interviews, events and activities, and Think College publications.

If you or someone you know would like to be interviewed, contact sheila.johnson@umb.edu for more information.



ThinkCollege

NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER

INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON

www.thinkcollege.net

Do you have any advice about college for parents of students with disabilities?

Don't over stress about your student going to college. Programs like CarolinaLIFE will work with you and your student and will support your student. College will help your student become more independent.

David, you recently earned your paraprofessional certification. Congratulations!

What does that mean to you?

This certification is a sense of accomplishment. It is a way to help me get involved in the field of education. It was stressful preparing for the exam, but it was worth it because now I get the opportunity to work in a classroom.

What kind of work will you be able to do now that you have this certification?

I will be able to work in a classroom setting with special needs students. I will work with students and help them succeed and grow.



CarolinaLIFE is an individualized, non-degree, certificate-based program for students with intellectual disability. The program philosophy is founded on inclusion and individualization, based on each student's interests and support needs. CarolinaLIFE students have access to opportunities offered to all University of South Carolina students such as participation in USC courses, on-campus housing, student organizations, sporting events, work-study, and commencement.

Learn more about CarolinaLife

[Visit their website](#)

[Learn about their 5 core focus areas](#)

[Learn about their peer-mentoring program](#)



ThinkCollege.net Resources for Students

[College Search](#)

This page has information on 300+ college programs for students with ID.

[Handouts in Plain and Clear Language](#)

These publications are written so they are easy to read and understand.

[Student Corner](#)

This webpage has articles and videos created just for students.

[Student Interviews and Stories](#)

These stories are about students' experiences before, during, and after college.



FOLLOW

www.thinkcollege.net



www.facebook.com/thinkcollege



www.twitter.com/thinkcollegeICI



CONTACT

thinkcollegeTA@gmail.com



SUBSCRIBE

www.thinkcollege.net/subscribe-to-mailing-list

This is a publication of the Think College National Coordinating Center, a project of the Institute for Community Inclusion at the University of Massachusetts Boston, funded by the Office of Postsecondary Education (Grant No. P407B15002). The opinions contained in this document are those of the grantee and do not necessarily reflect those of the funders.



ThinkCollege

NATIONAL COORDINATING CENTER

INSTITUTE FOR COMMUNITY INCLUSION, UMASS BOSTON